Ripe for Disaster: Where Supply Chains Break



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A place you've never heard of: Michoacán.

About **3 in 4** of Mexico's avocados grow in one state, Michoacán.

AND

90% of Mexico's avocado exports come to the United States.



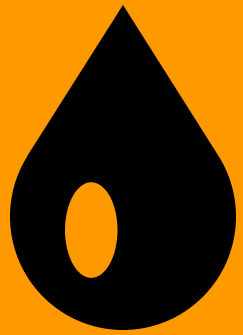


USDA Foreign Agricultural Service. GAIN Report MX2026-0019. "Avocado Annual." Guadalajara. March 12. 2026.

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The price tag leaves some things out...



Water

Soil in the avocado belt lost 68 billion liters of moisture, 2001–2018.
Barreras et al., 2026



Forests

Avocado expansion is linked to about 20% of Michoacán's deforestation, 2001–2017.
Cho et al., 2021

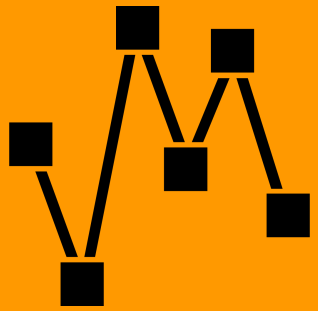


Conflict

In 2024, two US inspectors were assaulted and briefly held in Michoacán. Avocado inspections there were suspended.
Associated Press, 2024

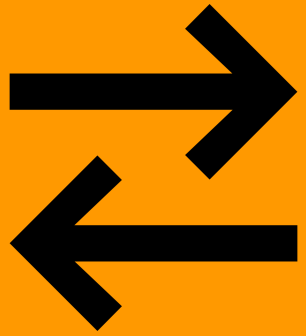
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Visualizing the problem with “GIS”



Collect

Public data on avocado production, homicides and forest loss.



Match

Every number tied to a place: one row per municipio.



Map

Patterns show up that no table can.

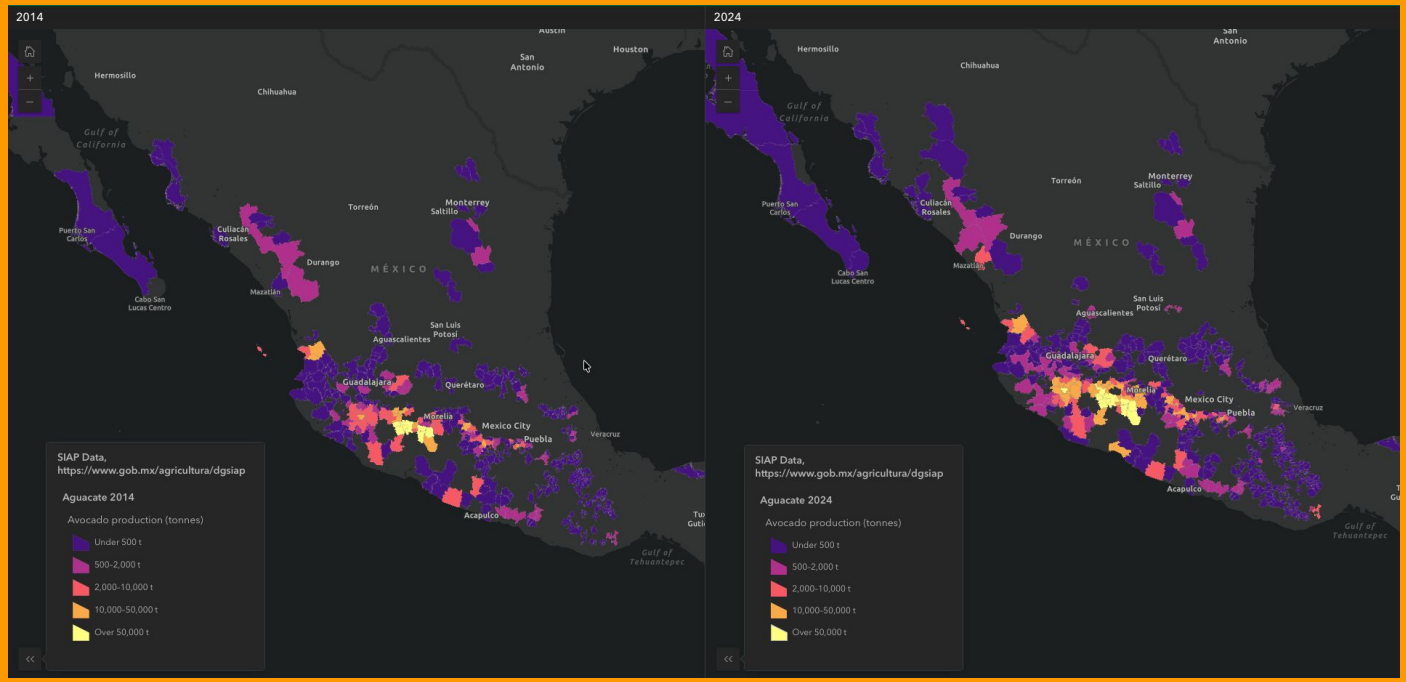
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Where the avocados are

80% → 73%

Michoacán's share of Mexico's avocado production by weight, 2014 to 2024

Still dominant, but Jalisco, approved to export to the US in 2022, is catching up.



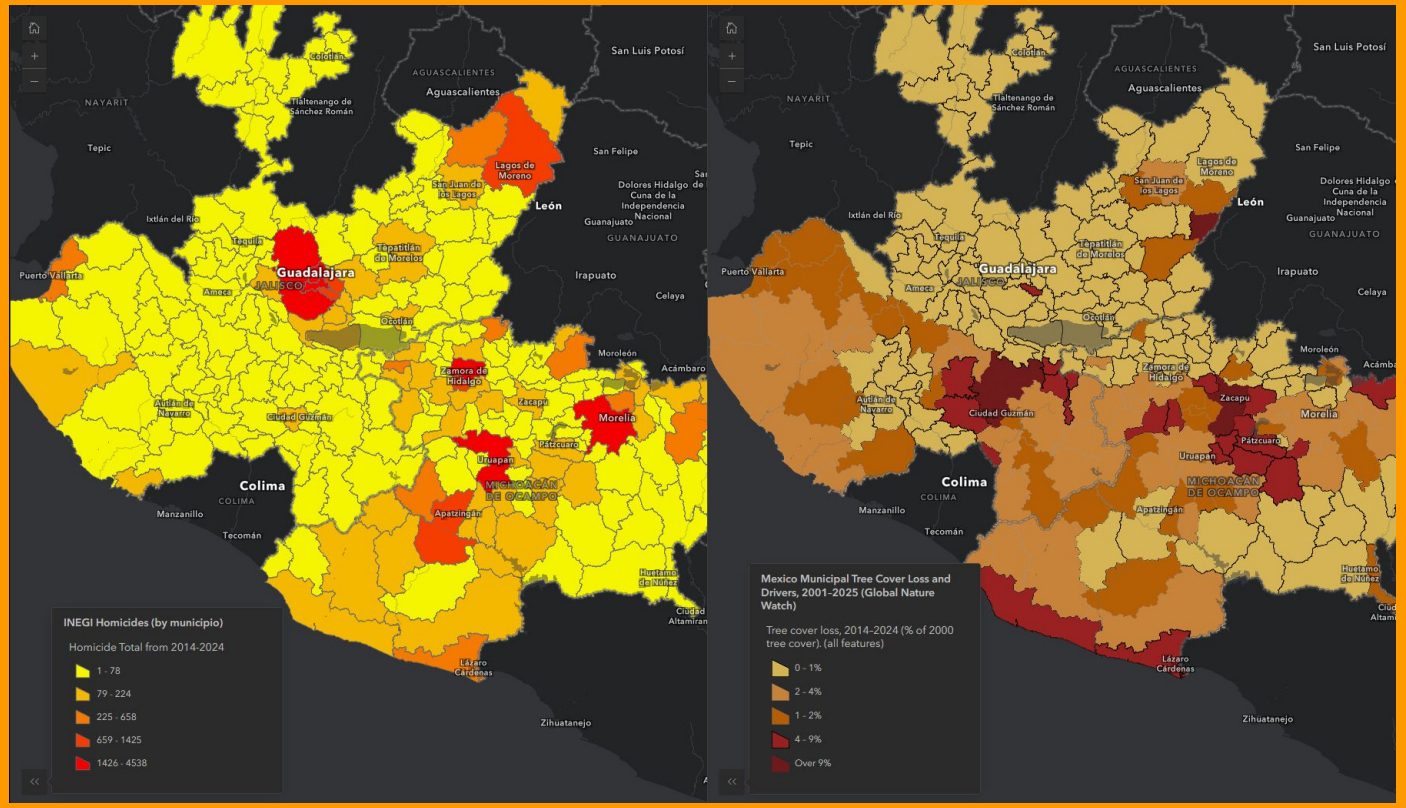
Production in tonnes by municipio. Areas with no color had no data reported. Source: SIAP Data.

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What the price tag leaves out

Left: Total homicides by municipio, 2014–2024 (INEGI). A proxy for violence.

Right: Tree cover loss, 2014–2024, as a share of 2000 tree cover. All causes, not only avocados.





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Questions? Contact

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Agricultural and Resource Economics, 2030

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